

Herbs That Drain Dampness

- Promote normal urination, increase urinary output, and eliminate bodily accumulation of water and dampness.
- Sweet and/or bland and neutral or cool herbs are commonly used to treat accumulation of water, dampness, and phlegm.
- Bitter or sweet and cold herbs drain damp-heat, and are commonly used to treat dysuria, infections in the genitourinary tract, or stones in the urinary tract.
- Lung, Spleen and Kidney control the circulation of water.
- When these organs fail to carry out their normal functions, disease occurs.
- Cautions: herbs that regulate water and drain dampness may deplete yin and body fluids.

Name	Similarities	Differences
Fu Ling (<i>Poria</i>)	Promote diuresis, leach out dampness, treat edema, and <i>lin zheng</i> (dysuria syndrome)	Strengthens the Spleen, calms the <i>shen</i> (spirit)
Fu Shen (<i>Poriae Sclerotium paradidis</i>)		***
Yi Yi Ren (<i>Semen Coicis</i>)		Strengthens the Spleen, treats <i>bi zheng</i> (painful obstruction syndrome) due to dampness, and clears heat to expel pus
Zhu Ling (<i>Polyporus</i>)		Exerts a stronger diuretic function than the others
Ze Xie (<i>Rhizoma Alismatis</i>)		Strongly promotes diuresis, clears deficient heat and damp-heat, and treats vertigo and dizziness caused by the accumulation of dampness.
Che Qian Zi (<i>Semen Plantaginis</i>)	Clear heat, promotes urination, treat shi-re lin. (damp-heat dysuria)	Clears heat from the Liver and Lung promotes urination to solidify the stool
Hua Shi (<i>Talcum</i>)		Clears summer-heat, clears heat, and promotes healing of damp sores when used externally
(Chuan) Mu Tong (<i>Caulis Clematidis Armandii</i>)		Sedates Heart fire, promotes lactation.
Tong Cao (<i>Medulla Tetrapanacis</i>)		Promotes lactation, weaker in clearing heat
Deng Xin Cao (<i>Medulla Junci</i>)		Clears Heart fire and eliminates irritability
Di Fu Zi (<i>Fructus Kochiae</i>)		Treats damp sores and relieves itching

Bian Xu (<i>Herba Polygoni Avicularis</i>)		Kills parasites and relieves itching
Qu Mai (<i>Herba Dianthi</i>)		Invigorates blood circulation, opens channels and collaterals, and treats amenorrhea.
Dong Gua Zi (<i>Semen Benincasae</i>)		Clears heat, dissolves phlegm, and eliminates pus
Yin Chen Hao (<i>Herba Artemisiae Scopariae</i>)		Reduces jaundice
Bei Xie (<i>Rhizoma Dioscoreae Hypoglaucae</i>)	Regulate water, promote urination, and reduce edema	Dispels dampness and treats cloudy urine, and treats arthritis
Dong Kui Zi (<i>Semen Malvae</i>)		Promotes lactation and treats constipation
Chi Xiao Dou (<i>Semen Phaseoli</i>)		Treats jaundice, clears toxins, treats abscesses, and swellings.
Jin Qian Cao (<i>Herba Lysimachiae</i>)	Dispels dampness, treats <i>re lin</i> (heat dysuria) and <i>shi lin</i> (stone dysuria)	Dispels gallstones and urinary stones, reduces jaundice
Hai Jin Sha (<i>Herba Lygodii</i>)		Treats <i>lin zheng</i> (dysuria syndrome)
Shi Wei (<i>Folium Pyrrosiae</i>)		Dissolves phlegm and relieves cough

Fú Líng 茯苓

- *Sclerotium Poriae Cocos*
- **English:** sclerotium of tuckahoe, china-root, poria
- **Properties:** sweet, bland, **neutral**
- **Channels:** Heart, Spleen, Kidney

Actions and Indications

Actions: Promotes urination and leaches out dampness

Indications- Used for urinary difficulty, diarrhea, or edema due to stagnation of fluids or dampness

Actions: Strengthens the Spleen and leaches out dampness

Indications –Used for Spleen deficiency with congested fluids in which phlegm moves upward, with such symptoms as palpitations, headache, dizziness, and a thick, greasy tongue coating. *Bai Zhu* (Formula: *wu ling san*)

Indications - Due to its neutral thermal properties, Fu Ling is frequently used to promote urination and eliminate dampness without damaging the qi.

- Dysuria: *Fu Ling, Zhu Ling*
- Damp-heat: *Che Qian Zi, Mu Tong*
- Cold-damp: *Fu Zi, Gan Jiang*
- Phlegm accumulation with vertigo, cough, and heart palpitations: *Bai Zhu (wu ling san)*

Actions: Strengthens the Spleen and harmonizes the middle burner:

Indications – Used for Spleen deficiency with dampness, leading to loss of appetite, diarrhea, and epigastric distension.

+ Dang Shen, Bai Zhu, Gan Cao

Main Actions:

- Promotes urination and leaches out dampness
- Strengthens the Spleen
- Calms spirit

Fú Shén 茯神

(Related to Fu Ling)

Actions: Quiets the Heart and calms the spirit

Indications –Used for palpitations, insomnia, or forgetfulness. *Zhu Sha, Suan Zao Ren, Yuan Zhi*

Main Actions:

- Promotes urination and leaches out dampness
- Strengthens the Spleen
- Calms spirit

Dosage: 10-15 grams in decoction.

Review questions:

Which channels does Fu Ling enter?

The property of Fu Ling (temp. and taste).

What herb leaches out dampness and tonifies the Spleen?

What are the indications of *Fu Ling Pi*, *Fu Shen*, & *Chi Fu Ling*?

Zhu Ling 猪苓

“pig’s fungus”

- *Sclerotium Polypori Umbellati*
- **English:** polyporus sclerotium

- **Properties:** sweet, bland, **slightly cool**
- **Channels:** Kidney, Urinary Bladder

Actions and Indications

Actions: Promotes urination and leaches out dampness:

Indications –Used for problems caused by stagnation of dampness, such as edema, scanty urine, vaginal discharge, cloudy, painful urinary dysfunction, as well as jaundice and diarrhea

Indications - Bland and neutral, it promotes urination, eliminates dampness, and reduces water accumulation.

- Zhu Ling is stronger in leaching out dampness than Fu Ling.
- Generalized edema: use Zhu Ling alone.
- Edema from Spleen deficiency: Fu Ling, Ze Xie (Formula: si ling san)

Dosage: 5-10 grams in decoction.

Cautions: *Zhu Ling* is not for patients with dizziness caused by yin deficiency or those experiencing thirst and dampness.

Main Actions:

- Promotes urination
- Leaches out dampness

Review questions:

- Which channels does Zhu Ling enter?
- The property of *Zhu Ling* (temp. and taste).
- The actions and indications of Zhu Ling?
- Compare *Fu Ling* and *Zhu Ling*.

Zé Xiè 泽泻 **“marsh drain”**

- *Rhizoma Alismatis Orientalis*
- **English:** water plantain rhizome, alisma
- **Properties:** sweet, bland, **cold**
- **Channels:** Kidney, Urinary Bladder

Actions and Indications

Actions: Promotes urination and leaches out dampness

Indications – for the stagnation associated with dampness, with such symptoms as urinary difficulty, edema, diarrhea, Lin zheng, leukorrhea, congested fluids or phlegm, especially lower jiao damp-heat.

Actions: Clears deficient heat from the Kidney:

Indications – for Kidney yin deficiency patterns with heat signs, including dizziness and tinnitus. *Bai Zhu (Formula: ze xie tang)*

Actions: Settles ministerial fire (xiang Huo 相火) in the Kidneys by draining damp-heat from the lower burner

Indications – for spermatorrhea, nocturnal emissions, and premature ejaculation due to lower burner damp-heat disturbing the ministerial fire of the Kidneys.

Main Actions:

- Promotes urination and leaches out dampness
- Clears heat (deficiency heat and damp-heat).

Dosage: 5-10 grams in decoction. Use up to 15, 18, or even 30 grams of Ze Xie in severe cases. Frying Ze Xie with salt enhances its effect of nourishing yin, purging heat, and regulating water circulation. Salt-frying Ze Xie is commonly used to treat knee and lower back weakness and pain.

Review questions:

- The actions and indications of Ze Xie
- Compare Fu Ling, Zhu Ling, and Ze Xie.
- What herbs clear deficiency heat?
- What herbs treat lower jiao damp-heat?

Yi Yi Ren 薏苡仁

- *Semen Coicis Lachryma-jobi*
- **English:** coix seeds, Job's tears
- **Properties:** sweet, bland, **slightly cold**
- **Channels:** Spleen, Lung, Kidney

Actions and Indications

Actions: Promotes urination, leaches out dampness, and strengthens the Spleen

Indications –Used for all types of accumulation of dampness or water leading to symptoms such as edema, urinary difficulty, and diarrhea.

Actions: Resolves dampness and releases spasms (pain)

Indications – for wind-damp painful obstruction with tightness and spasm of the tendons restricting flexibility.

Actions: Clears heat and expels pus:

Indications – Lung or intestinal abscess.

- Lung abscess: *Yu Xing Cao, Dong Gua Ren*
- Intestinal abscess: *Bai Jiang Cao, Hong Teng, Dan Pi*

Main Actions:

- Promotes urination and leaches out dampness
- Strengthens the Spleen
- Resolves dampness and releases spasms
- Clears heat and dispels pus

Dosage: 10-30 grams in decoction.

Note: *Yi Yi Ren* must be taken in large doses for a long time, since it is relatively mild. The unprepared herb is better to clear heat and regulate water circulation. The dry-fried herb is better to tonify the Spleen and relieve diarrhea.

Review Questions:

- Actions and indications of Yi Yi Ren
- Compare Yi Yi Ren and Fu Ling
- List the herbs that clear heat and dispel pus.

Chē Qián Zǐ 车前子

“seed in front of cart” “seed-before-cart”

- *Semen Plantaginis*
- **English:** plantago seeds
- **Properties:** sweet, cold
- **Channels:** Urinary Bladder, Kidney, Liver, Lung

Actions and Indications

Actions: Promotes urination and clears heat

Indications –Used for any type of edema or painful urinary dysfunction (lin zheng) due to damp heat.

Actions: Promotes urination to solidify the stool

Indications – Used for diarrhea associated with either damp-heat or damp summerheat.
+ *Bai Zhu, Fu Ling, Ze Xie*

Actions: Clears Liver heat and benefits the eyes

Indications –Used for problems caused by Liver fire and headaches provoked by Liver yang rising or Liver and Kidney yin deficiency.

- Liver fire: *Ju Hua, Long Dan Cao, Huang Qin*
- Liver and Kidney deficiency: *Gou Qi Zi, Sheng Di, Mai Dong*.

Actions: Clears Lung heat, transforms phlegm, and stops cough

Indications –Used for Lung heat-induced cough with copious sputum

Main Actions:

- Promotes urination and clears heat
- Promotes urination to solidify the stool
- Clears Liver heat and benefits the eyes
- Clears Lung heat and transforms phlegm

Dosage: 5 - 10 grams in decoction.

- Place *Che Qian Zi* in cheesecloth when decocting to maximize cooking efficiency.
- Frying the herb with salt directs its effects to the lower part of the body.

Review questions:

- The property of *Che Qian Zi*
- The actions and indications of *Che Qian Zi*
- For treating damp-heat leading to edema or UTI.
- How does *Che Qian Zi* treat diarrhea?
- Herbs for treating eye conditions (Xu & Shi).
- What is the special preparation when making a decoction?

Huá Shí 滑石
“slippery rock”

- *Talcum*
- **English:** talcum
- **Properties:** sweet, bland, **cold**
- **Channels:** Stomach, Urinary Bladder

Actions and Indications

Actions: Promotes urination and clears heat from the bladder

Indications –Used for any type of edema or painful urinary dysfunction due to damp heat + *Mu Tong, Che Qian Zi, Da Huang* (Formula: *ba zheng san*)

Actions: Clears summer heat and releases summer-damp

Indications –Used for summer heat disorder with fever, urinary difficulty, irritability, and thirst

+ *Gan Cao* (Formula: *liu yi san*)

Actions: Used topically to clear heat and absorb dampness (astringent)

Indications – applied topically for damp skin disorders, including eczema, rash, and athlete’s foot. + *Duan Shi Gao*, apply as a powder topically

Main Actions:

- Promotes urination and clears heat from the bladder
- Clears summer damp-heat
- Used topically to clear heat and absorb dampness

Dosage: 10-15 grams in decoction.

Note: *Hua Shi* should be wrapped in cheesecloth for decoction.

Review Questions

- The properties of *Hua Shi*.
- Herbs for treating damp-heat leading to edema or UTI.
- Herbs for treating summer heat or summer damp-heat.
- Herbs for topical application for a damp skin disorder.
- How to use *Hua Shi* when making a decoction or for topical use?

Mù Tōng 木通

“open-ended wood”

- *Caulis Clematidis Armandii* (*Chu Mu Tong*)
- *Caulis Aristolochiae Manshuriensis* (*Guan Mu Tong*)
- **English:** akebia caulis
- **Properties:** bitter, cool
- **Channels:** Urinary Bladder, Heart, Small Intestine

Actions and Indications

Actions: Promotes urination and drains heat from the Heart via the Small Intestine

Indications –Used for such symptoms as irritability accompanied by mouth or tongue sores and scanty urine. (Formulas: *dao chi san*, *ba zheng san*)

Actions: Promotes lactation

Indications – for insufficient lactation.

Note: Make soup with *Wang Bu Liu Xing*, *Chuan Shan Jia*, and pig feet.

Main Actions:

- Promotes urination

- Drains heat from the Heart via the Small Intestine
- Promotes lactation

Dosage: 3-6 grams in decoction. Overdose of *Guan Mu Tong* (over 60 grams) has been associated with nephropathy.

Cautions: Guan Mu Tong is contraindicated during pregnancy and in cases of compromised kidney function.

Overdose: overdose of *Guan Mu Tong* may cause upper abdominal discomfort, nausea, vomiting, diarrhea, abdominal distention, poor appetite, headache, chest congestion, facial edema, palpitations, frequent urination, low back pain, edema of the entire body, dysuria, anuria, increased blood pressure, delirium, proteinuria, increased protein nitrogen in blood and urine, and hyperkalemia.

Review questions:

- Actions and indications of Mu Tong
- How does Mu Tong treat heart heat?
- The herbs promote lactation.
- What are the cautions and toxic effects of Guan Mu Tong?

Tōng Cǎo 通草 “unblocking grass”

- *Medulla Tetrapanax Papyriferi*
- **English:** rice paper plant pith, tetrapanax
- **Properties:** sweet, bland, **slightly cold**
- **Channels:** Lung, Stomach

Actions and Indications

Actions: Promotes urination and clears heat

Indications –Used for damp warm-febrile diseases or damp-heat painful urinary dysfunction

Actions: Promotes lactation in cases where it is insufficient or absent

Indications –Used for insufficient lactation

Main Actions:

- Promotes urination and clears heat
- Promotes lactation

Dosage: 2-5 grams. Use 15-18 grams of *Tong Cao* when the intent is to promote lactation.

Cautions: Tong Cao is not recommended for pregnant women

Review questions

- Actions and indications of Tong Cao
- Compare *Mu Tong* and *Tong Cao*.
- The herbs promote lactation.

Bēi Xiè 萆 薢

- *Rhizoma Dioscoreae Hypoglaucae*
- **English:** tokoro
- **Properties:** bitter, neutral
- **Channels:** Urinary Bladder, Liver, and Stomach

Actions and Indications

Actions: Leaches out dampness and separates the pure from the turbid

Indications –Used for resolving turbid dampness in the lower burner, manifesting in cloudy urine or vaginal discharge. + *Yi Zhi Ren*, *Wu Yao*

Actions: Expels wind-dampness, relaxes the sinews, and unblocks the connecting channels.

Indications –Used for wind-damp or damp-heat painful obstruction with low back pain, numbness or stiffness of the lower extremities, or muscle aches

Main Actions:

- Leaches out dampness and separates pure from turbid
- Expels wind-damp

Dosage: 10-15 grams.

Review questions

- Actions and indications of Bei Xie
- What is the most effective herb for cloudy lin?

Yīn Chén Hāo 茵 陈 蒿 “mattress old wormwood”

- *Herba Artemisiae Yinchenhao*
- **English:** yinchenhao shoots and leaves, capillaris
- **Properties:** bitter, acrid, cool
- **Channels:** Liver, Gallbladder, Spleen, Stomach

Actions and Indications

Actions: Clears damp-heat from the Liver and Gall Bladder and relieves jaundice:

Indications –Use this as the principal herb and most effective herb for treating jaundice due to either damp-heat or damp-cold conditions.

- *Yin Chen Hao* can be used individually in large doses.
- Jaundice due to damp-heat: *Da Huang, Zhi Zi* (Formula: *yin chen hao tang*)
- Jaundice from damp-cold: *Fu Zi, Gan Jiang* (Formula: *yin chen si ni tang*)

Main Actions:

- Clears damp-heat and relieves jaundice

Dosage: 10-30 grams in decoction or tea.

Caution: *Yin Chen Hao* is contraindicated if there is not damp-heat present.

Review questions

- What is the “yao yao” or principal herb for treating jaundice?
- The herbs can be used to treat jaundice.

Dì Fū Zǐ 地肤子

“earth skin seed”

- *Fructus Kochiae Scopariae*
- **English:** broom cypress or kochia fruit
- **Properties:** sweet, bitter, **cold**
- **Channels:** Urinary Bladder

Actions and Indications

Actions: Clears damp-heat and promotes urination:

Indications –Used for painful urinary dysfunction due to damp-heat accumulating in the Bladder with such symptoms as dark, burning, and scanty urine

Actions: Expels dampness and stops itching:

Indications –used both internally and topically for damp skin disorders and other dermatological problems where itching is a major symptom, such as eczema and scabies

Main Actions:

- Clears damp-heat and promotes urination
- Expels dampness and stops itching

Dosage: 10-15 grams in decoction.

Review questions

- The actions and indications of Di Fu Zi.
- List the most common herbs that treat itchy skin.

Dōng Guā Pí 冬瓜皮
“wintermelon peel”

- *Epicarpium Benincasae Hispidae*
- **English:** winter melon skin
- **Properties:** sweet, **slightly cold**
- **Channels:** Lung, Small Intestine

Actions and Indications

Actions: Promotes urination, reduces edema, and clears heat:

Indications – it is most commonly used for edema due to heat or summer-heat

Dōng Guā Zǐ 冬瓜子
“wintermelon seeds”

- *Semen Benincasae*
- **Literal Name:** winter melon seed
- English Name: benincasa, Chinese wax gourd seed
- **Properties:** sweet, **cold**
- **Channels:** Lung, Stomach, Small Intestine and Large Intestine

Actions and Indications

Actions: Clears heat, dissolves phlegm, and eliminates pus

Indications: Lung abscess with foul-smelling sputum, or intestinal abscess

- Bronchitis with cough, yellow sputum, and sore throat: Dong Gua Zi, Bo He, Xing Ren, Qian Hu, Niu Bang Zi, *and She Gan*.
- Bronchitis with dry cough and possibly scanty blood-streaked sputum: combine Dong Gua Zi with Xing Ren, Ban Xia, Sheng Di Huang, Nan Sha Shen, Chuan Bei Mu, Ce Bai Ye, and *Qian Cao*.

Actions: Promotes urination (Pi and seeds)

Indication-Used for edema. *Dong Gua Zi* is a relatively mild herb that treats edema caused by nephritis and dysuria. It should be combined with other herbs to enhance its effectiveness.

Main Actions:

- Promotes urination, reduces edema, and clears heat (winter melon peels & seeds)
- Clears heat, dissolves phlegm, and eliminates pus (winter melon seeds)

Dosage: 10 to 15 grams. Unprocessed *Dong Gua Zi* has a stronger effect to dissolve phlegm, dispel pus and abscesses, regulate water circulation, and treat edema. Dry-fried *Dong Gua Zi* functions better to warm the Spleen and Stomach, and eliminate dampness.

Dong Gua Pi & Zi 冬瓜皮,子**Review questions:**

- Property, actions, and indications of these two herbs
- What are the differences between these two herbs?
- Review the herbs from previous sections for treating Lung and intestinal abscess.

Biǎn Xù 扁 蓄

- *Herba Polygoni Avicularis*
- **English:** common knotgrass herb
- **Properties:** bitter, **cold**
- **Channels:** Urinary Bladder

Actions and Indications**Actions: Clears damp-heat and promotes urination**

Indication- for *re lin* (dysuria syndrome) or *xue* (blood) *lin* with burning and pain: *Bian Xu*, *Mu Tong*, *Hua Shi* (Formula: *ba zheng san*)

Actions: Kills parasites and relieves itching

Indications –Used for eczema, anal and genital itching.

Indications- It treats tinea, oozing sores, and damp skin lesions. It can be taken internally or applied topically.

Main Actions:

- Clears damp-heat from the lower jiao and promotes urination
- Kills parasites and stops itching

Dosage: 10-15 grams. It can be used internally and externally.

Review questions

- Actions and indications of *Bian Xu*
- What is the other herb commonly combined with *Bian Xu*?

Qú Mài 瞿麦

- *Herba Dianthi*
- **English:** aerial parts of fringed pink or Chinese pink
- **Properties:** bitter, **cold**
- **Channels:** Urinary Bladder, Heart, Small Intestine

Actions and Indications

Actions: Clears damp-heat, promotes urination, and unblocks painful urinary dysfunction

Indications –Used for any type of painful urinary dysfunction, especially bloody dysuria

Actions: Invigorates blood and unblocks channels:

Indications – used as an auxiliary herb for amenorrhea due to blood stasis

Main Actions:

- Promotes urination and unblocks lin syndrome

Dosage: 10-15 grams in decoction.

Cautions: The use of Qu Mai is contraindicated in pregnant women, as it stimulates uterine contractions.

Review questions

- The actions and indications of Qu Mai?
- What are the properties of *Bian Xu* and *Qu Mai*?
- Compare *Bian Xu* and *Qu Mai*.

Dēng Xīn Cǎo 灯心草

“lamp wick herb”

- *Medulla Junci Effusi*
- **English:** rush pith, juncus
- **Properties:** sweet, bland, **slightly cold**
- **Channels:** Heart, Lung, Small Intestine

Actions and Indications

Actions: Promotes urination and leaches out dampness

Indications –Used for heat disorders with dark, scanty urine or for hot, painful urinary dysfunction

Actions: Clears heat from the Heart and eliminates irritability

Indications – insomnia, irritability, and infantile crying at night. Apply charred *Deng Xin Cao* to the nipple and let the infant suckle.

Main Actions:

- Promotes urination and unblocks lin syndrome.
- Clears heat from the Heart and eliminates irritability.

Dosage: 1.5-2.5 grams in decoction or pills.

Review questions

- The actions and indications of Deng Xin Cao?
- Herbs that promote urination and leach out dampness.
- What herb can be used for infantile crying at night?

Dōng Kuí Zǐ 冬葵子

- *Semen Abutili seu Malvae*
- **English:** musk mallow seeds
- **Properties:** sweet, cold
- **Channels:** Urinary Bladder, Large Intestine, Small Intestine

Actions and Indications**Actions: Promotes urination and unblocks painful urinary dysfunction:**

Indications – for edema or urinary disorders, including difficult urination; hot, bloody or stony painful urinary dysfunction

Actions: Promotes lactation:

Indications – for insufficient lactation, painful swollen breasts or early stages of breast abscess

Actions: Moistens the Intestines and unblocks the bowels:

Indications – used as an adjunctive herb for constipation due to insufficient fluid in the Intestines

Main Actions:

- Promotes urination and unblocks lin syndrome.
- Promotes lactation
- Moistens the Intestine

Dosage: 10-15 grams

Cautions: Use Dong Kui Zi carefully in pregnant women or in patients who have deficiency and cold of the Spleen and Stomach.

Review questions

- The actions and indications of *Dong Kui Zi*.
- Herbs promote lactation.
- What herbs moisten the Intestine?
- Caution during pregnancy.

Jīn Qián Cǎo 金钱草 “gold money herb” “golden coin grass

- *Herba Lysimachiae*
- **English:** Lysimachia
- **Properties:** sweet, bland, **neutral**
- **Channels:** Urinary Bladder, Gallbladder, Kidney, Liver

Actions and Indications

Actions: Promotes urination, unblocks painful urinary dysfunction and expels stones

Indications – for various types of painful urinary dysfunction, such as Re lin and Stone lin. It can be used alone or combined with *Hai Jin Sha*, *Ji Nei Jin*.

Actions: Clears damp-heat in the Liver and Gallbladder

<http://www.dmacgroup.com/HealthDigest.htm>

Indications –Used for gallstones, jaundice, and hepatitis due to damp-heat. (Formula: *Yin Chen Hao*) + *Zhi Zi*

Actions: Eliminates toxins and reduces swelling

Indications - for snake bite, sores, and lesions.

The fresh form of this herb can be mashed and applied topically or juiced for internal use.

Main Actions:

- Promotes urination, clears damp-heat, and expels stones
- Clears damp-heat in the Liver and Gallbladder

Dosage: 15-30 grams. The maximum dosage for *Jin Qian Cao* is 60 grams. Double that if using fresh herb.

Review questions:

- Actions and indications of Jin Qian Cao
- What is the main condition this herb is used for?

- Herbs for treating Liver/GB damp-heat conditions.

Hǎi Jīn Shā 海金沙
“golden sand of the sea”

- *Spora Lygodii Japonici*
- **English:** sea gold sand
- **Properties:** sweet, **cool**
- **Channels:** Urinary Bladder, Small Intestine

Actions and Indications

Actions: Clears heat and promotes urination:

Indications –Used for hot or stony painful urinary dysfunction, such as Lin syndrome, urinary stones, and gallstones.

Dosage: 6-15 grams. *Hai Jin Sha* should be wrapped in cheesecloth to maximize saturation when cooking in decoction.

Review questions

- Actions and indications of Hai Jin Sha.
- What is the main indication of Jin Qian Cao and Hai Jin Sha?

Shí Wěi 石葦
“stone reed”

- *Folium Pyrrosiae*
- **English:** Pyrrosia leaves
- **Properties:** bitter, sweet, **slightly cold**
- **Channels:** Urinary Bladder, Lung

Actions and Indications

Actions: Promotes urination and unblocks painful urinary dysfunction:

Indications –Used for hot, stony, or bloody painful urinary dysfunction due to damp-heat

Actions: Clears the Lung, transforms phlegm, and stops cough:

Indications –Used for Lung heat cough, wheezing. Recently used for treating acute or chronic bronchitis.

Actions: Clears heat and stops bleeding:

Indications –Used for bleeding due to reckless movement of hot blood, especially in cases of vomiting blood, uterine bleeding, and bloody painful urinary dysfunction

Main Actions:

- Promotes urination and unblocks Lin.
- Stops coughing
- Stops bleeding

Dosage: 5-10 grams in decoction.

Review questions

- Actions and indications of Shi Wei.
- What are the most common indications of Jin Qian Cao, Hai Jin Sha, and Shi Wei?

Chì Xiǎo Dòu 赤小豆
“red little bean”

- *Semen Phaseoli Calcarati*
- **English:** Aduki bean, Phaseolus
- **Properties:** sweet, sour, **neutral**
- **Channels:** Heart, Small Intestine

Actions and Indications

Actions: Clears heat, promotes urination, and reduces swelling:

Indications – for abdominal swelling and fullness due to edema, urinary difficulty, and leg qi edema

Actions: Eliminates fire toxicity from skin and drains pus:

Indications –Used for sores, carbuncles, and furuncles

Indications- Swelling and abscesses that have not ulcerated: Mix *Chi Xiao Dou* powder with egg white, honey, or vinegar and apply topically.

Indications- Skin lesions with no abscess: Make a decoction of *Chi Xiao Dou* and use it as a topical wash.

Main Actions:

- Promotes urination and reduces swelling
- Eliminates toxins and drains pus
- Treats jaundice due to damp-heat.

Dosage: 10-30 grams in decoction.

Review questions:

- Actions and indications of Dong Gua Pi & Chi Xiao Dou.
- Herbs can be used as food therapy; they have mild actions to promote urination and reduce puffiness (mild edema)